

In a pact with Bell Helicopters, India pushes defence manufacturing

India's Tata Advanced Systems has entered into a contract with USA based Bell Helicopters to make and assemble naval choppers, as Indian companies rush to expand their defence business after the government began encouraging private participation in the sector. The Tata-Bell tie-up will be in direct competition with Mahendra-Airbus partnership for a slice of India's helicopter purchases.

Maharashtra plans to increase solar power use in agriculture

Maharashtra, one of the largest states in India, is planning to shift all its electricity consumers in the agricultural sector from using thermal power to solar power.

Mouser Electronics expands India operations

Emphasizing its commitment to the Indian market, Mouser Electronics has announced the opening of its new and larger customer service centre and back-office support location in

Bengaluru. The new full-service office underscores Mouser's steadfast dedication to serving the world's top design engineers and buyers with the highest degree of customer service and technical support, as well as offering local marketing support to its suppliers and media partners in the region.

Panasonic to integrate AI in new products

Panasonic India is looking for companies with whom it can partner to develop artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning technologies. It plans to assimilate these technologies in its future smartphones so that these stand out in the populous Indian market.

India invites Silicon Valley professionals to back Startup India movement

Minister of road transport, highways and shipping, Nitin Gadkari, has invited Silicon Valley professionals of Indian origin to participate in Startup India movement.

period of five months.

Eveready, which once derived most of its revenue from batteries, has successfully diversified into the LED lighting business and is one of the biggest brands in LED lights in India. It now sells more than 1.2 billion batteries and nearly 25 million flash lights.

Telit, Tech Mahindra to collaborate on end-to-end IoT solutions

Telit, a global enabler of the Internet of Things (IoT), has announced its multi-faceted collaboration with Tech Mahindra on developing complete solutions for the IoT. The relationship is centred on combining and integrating Telit's leading portfolio of IoT products and services with Tech Mahindra's system integration expertise and strengths in developing end-to-

end enterprise solutions.

Both companies are also jointly pursuing new business opportunities across many markets and industries such as IoT horizontal and industrial IoT around the world. Additionally, Telit has reached an agreement to outsource related engineering development and testing activities to Tech Mahindra.

LG to make premium products in India

LG Electronics, one of the largest white goods maker, will now manufacture all its premium products and the entire mobile phone range in India, and may set up a third plant in the country to cater to the Northeast region. LG India managing director Ki Wan Kim has said that the company's strategy is to launch new premium products, create the market,

take leadership and eventually manufacture these in India.

He also said that premium appliances, new categories like air and water purifiers and smartphones would help the Korean brand return to high growth momentum. The company grew around ten per cent year-on-year in January to June period of 2016, and it expects similar growth for the rest of the year.

Karbonn to set up television unit in Noida

Indian handset maker Karbonn Mobiles is planning to enter the television market by launching its smart TVs in November 2016, besides manufacturing accessories and batteries in the next two months. The company is investing ₹ 1.5 billion to set up a new smart TV manufacturing unit in Noida, Uttar Pradesh, which will be operational by April 2017.

Till November, the company will use existing facilities for the smart TVs. According to Pardeep Jain, managing director, Karbonn Mobiles, the company wants to position their smart TVs as an extension of smartphones.

Microsoft appoints Crayon for CSP programme

Microsoft has announced the appointment of Crayon Software Experts India (Crayon) as a cloud distribution partner under its Cloud Solutions Provider (CSP) programme in India. As part of the programme, Crayon will help customers (both SMBs and enterprises) in India to adopt Microsoft's Cloud based technology solutions like Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Office 365, Windows Intune and Enterprise Mobility Suite subscriptions.

Crayon will also work with Internet service providers, telecommunications providers and Web hosting firms to deliver these solutions to customers in India.